

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
5 FOR ENGROSSED
6 SENATE BILL NO. 1317

By: Dossett of the Senate

and

Provenzano of the House

11 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

12 An Act relating to teachers; amending 70 O.S. 2021,
13 Section 6-101.3, which relates to definitions for
14 teachers; modifying definition for career teacher for
15 evaluation purposes; and providing an effective date.

17 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

18 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-101.3, is
19 amended to read as follows:

20 Section 6-101.3. As used in Section 6-101 et seq. of this
21 title:

22 1. "Administrator" means a duly certified person who devotes a
23 majority of time to service as a superintendent, elementary
24

1 superintendent, principal, supervisor, vice principal or in any
2 other administrative or supervisory capacity in the school district;

3 2. "Dismissal" means the discontinuance of the teaching service
4 of an administrator or teacher during the term of a written
5 contract, as provided by law;

6 3. "Nonreemployment" means the nonrenewal of the contract of an
7 administrator or teacher upon expiration of the contract;

8 4. "Career teacher" means a teacher who:

9 a. is employed by a school district prior to the 2017-
10 2018 school year and has completed three (3) or more
11 consecutive complete school years as a teacher in one
12 school district under a written continuing or
13 temporary teaching contract, ~~or~~

14 b. is employed for the first time by a school district
15 under a written continuing or temporary teaching
16 contract during the 2017-2018 school year and
17 thereafter, and:

18 (1) has completed three (3) consecutive complete
19 school years as a teacher in one school district
20 under a written continuing or temporary teaching
21 contract and has achieved a district evaluation
22 rating of "superior" as measured pursuant to the
23 TLE as set forth in Section 6-101.16 of this
24

1 title for at least two (2) of the three (3)
2 school years,

3 (2) has completed four (4) consecutive complete
4 school years as a teacher in one school district
5 under a written continuing or temporary teaching
6 contract, has averaged a district evaluation
7 rating of at least "effective" as measured
8 pursuant to the TLE for the four-year period, and
9 has received district evaluation ratings of at
10 least "effective" for the last two (2) years of
11 the four-year period, or

12 (3) has completed four (4) or more consecutive
13 complete school years in one school district
14 under a written continuing or temporary teaching
15 contract and has not met the requirements of
16 subparagraph a or b of this paragraph, only if
17 the principal of the school at which the teacher
18 is employed submits a petition to the
19 superintendent of the school district requesting
20 that the teacher be granted career status, the
21 superintendent agrees with the petition, and the
22 school district board of education approves the
23 petition. The principal shall specify in the
24

petition the underlying facts supporting the granting of career status to the teacher, or
c. after meeting the requirements of subparagraph a or b of this paragraph in one school district, is employed by another school district under a written continuing or temporary teaching contract and the board of education of the school district has approved the granting of career status to the teacher. Status as a career teacher pursuant to this paragraph shall be for evaluation purposes only;

5. "Teacher hearing" means the hearing before a school district board of education after a recommendation for dismissal or nonreemployment of a teacher has been made but before any final action is taken on the recommendation, held for the purpose of affording the teacher all rights guaranteed by the United States Constitution and the Constitution of Oklahoma under circumstances and for enabling the board to determine whether to approve or disapprove the recommendation;

6. "Probationary teacher" means a teacher who:

- a. is employed by a school district prior to the 2017-2018 school year and has completed fewer than three (3) consecutive complete school years as a teacher in one school district under a written teaching contract, or

b. is employed for the first time by a school district under a written teaching contract during the 2017-2018 school year and thereafter and has not met the requirements for career teacher as provided in paragraph 4 of this section;

7. "Suspension" or "suspended" means the temporary discontinuance of the services of an administrator or teacher, as provided by law;

8. "Teacher" means a person defined as a teacher in Section 1-116 of this title; and

9. "District evaluation rating" means the rating issued based on the components of the TLE as set forth in subsection B of Section 6-101.16 of this title.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON EDUCATION OVERSIGHT, dated 04/14/2026 - DO PASS, As Amended.